Sweden: SI Scholarship for Global Professionals: Submission Pack

University application by 15 Jan 2027 · SI scholarship 8–24 Feb 2027 (portal closes 14:59 CET)

Evidence:

- SI and University Admissions facts are **verified on the official sites (E1)**, re-read on 8 Nov 2026.
- University programme requirements are **search-indexed (E2)**: confirm them on each university page.

1. Official links (E1)

Purpose	URL
SI scholarship page (rules, templates from 13 Nov, eligible programmes)	https://si.se/en/apply/scholarships/swedish-institute-scholarships-for-global-professionals/
SI FAQ	https://si.se/en/apply/faq-scholarships-on-masters-level/
University application (programme search and apply)	https://www.universityadmissions.se
Key dates	https://www.universityadmissions.se/en/key-dates-and-deadlines/autumn-semester-dates/
Application fee	https://www.universityadmissions.se/en/apply-to-masters/pay-your-application-fee-non-eueea-masters/
Documents from Ethiopia	https://www.universityadmissions.se/en/apply-to-masters/provide-application-documents-masters/country-instructions/ethiopia/

2. Eligibility: the Ethiopian 3,000-hour condition (verified E1, 8 Nov 2026)

- **Countries:** Ethiopia is listed among the SI target countries.
- **Hours:** “must have at least 3,000 hours of work experience prior to 8 February 2027 … The 3,000 hours must have been accumulated from a maximum of three employers.” “If you cannot provide proof for a total of 3,000 hours … your application will be deemed ineligible.”
- **What counts:** full-time or part-time employment, freelancing or entrepreneurship. **Internships do not count.**
- **Formula:** hours/week × weeks/year × years.
- **Your case:** you report about **3 years 6 months** of work since 2022. At 40 h × 48 weeks that is roughly **6,700 hours**, comfortably above 3,000, **but only if the HR letters prove the dates and weekly hours**.
  - The sheet “SI hours - no double count” in `09_APPLICATION_DOCUMENTS/00_Document_Collection_Kit/Employment_Evidence_Collection_Form_v2.xlsx` counts overlapping jobs only once.
  - Until the letters arrive, eligibility is **pending, not assumed**.
- **Leadership:** required, from employment, entrepreneurship or civil society. No minimum hours; “priority will be given to … strong and relevant leadership experience from employment”.
- **Not eligible if you:**

- hold or are enrolled in a Swedish degree
- have lived in Sweden for 2+ years
- previously held an SI scholarship
- have EU/EEA citizenship or certain Swedish permits

None applies to you, as far as your profile shows.

- **English (universities):** a completely documented Ethiopian bachelor's degree meets the requirement (E1).

3. Programmes (provisional until SI's list on 13 Nov)

From `SI_Programme_Shortlist.xlsx` (application codes and tuition E1; entry requirements E2):

Rank	Programme	Why
1	Luleå University of Technology: Master Programme in Information Security (MASTERHT27-LTU-97403/-97401)	You meet the stated requirement (≥ 180 ECTS in computing or equivalent); no maths requirement listed
2	Stockholm University: Master's Programme in Information Security (MASTERHT27-SU-43004)	Any 180-ECTS bachelor's; selection includes a **motivation letter** (draft in section 4c)
3	Karlstad University: Master's Programme in Cybersecurity (MASTERHT27-KAU-80917)	Your courses appear to cover the listed CS areas
4	Karlstad University: Intelligent Communication Systems (MASTERHT27-KAU-80919) **or** Luleå Cyber Security	Same requirement / you meet the stated course minimums

Avoid Linköping Cybersecurity (it requires calculus, which your transcript does not show).

Rank by your real preference. SI can fund only the programme you are admitted to on 1 April.

4. Written responses (complete drafts; rewrite in your own words)

4a. SI motivation (portal text, about 520 words)

> **My work and why it matters.** Ethiopia is moving quickly from cash to digital payments. For merchants, schools and families, a reliable payment service is part of economic participation, and every failure pushes people back to cash. Since [month year] I have worked at SantimPay Financial Solution S.C. in Addis Ababa, a fintech company that provides POS, QR, school-payment and payment-gateway services with Ethiopian banks. As [title(s) from the HR letter], I [two or three verified responsibilities]. Before that / in parallel I worked at Kifiya Financial Technology PLC as [title], where I [verified duty].
>
> **Leadership.** [One real example in 3–4 sentences, using SI's definition: leading colleagues, allocating tasks, influencing decisions, e.g. "When we rolled out … to N merchants, I coordinated a team of N colleagues, decided …, and as a result …"]. [Optional second example: Dereja co-training, 2022: supporting trainees and reporting their progress (confirm dates and numbers).]

Why this programme. Most of my work today is reacting to problems. I need the systematic knowledge to design secure and resilient digital infrastructure: risk management, secure system design and security governance. [Programme name] offers [two specific courses from the official curriculum], which I cannot learn on the job. I chose Sweden because of its strength in trustworthy digital public infrastructure, and its open, cooperative way of working.

Contribution to sustainable development. My studies connect directly to **SDG 9** (resilient infrastructure and innovation), **SDG 8** (inclusive economic growth: reliable digital payments let small businesses join the formal economy) and **SDG 16** (trustworthy institutions: secure systems protect citizens' money and data). Ethiopia's national digital strategy depends on payment and identity systems that people can trust. Engineers who understand both the technology and the governance of security are scarce.

My plan after the degree. I will return to Ethiopia's financial-technology sector to lead security and reliability engineering for payment platforms. Within five years I aim to [a realistic goal, e.g. lead the infrastructure-security team of a fintech or bank]. I will share what I learn through [a real commitment: workshops for Computer Science students at Debre Tabor University; mentoring junior engineers], and I will stay connected to Sweden through the Swedish Institute's scholar and alumni network.

Why me. I bring hands-on experience of keeping critical financial services running in a fast-growing market, a record of steady academic improvement (my final year was my strongest), and a clear plan to apply what I learn where it is most needed.

4b. If SI selects you for a short video presentation

Use the same five blocks in 2 minutes:

1. Work.
2. One leadership example.
3. Programme.
4. SDGs.
5. Plan.

Practise once on camera.

4c. Stockholm University: motivation letter (1 A4 page; check the page for autumn-2027 rules)

Dear Admissions Committee,

I am applying to the Master's Programme in Information Security because my daily work depends on it. At SantimPay in Addis Ababa I [verified duties] for payment services used by merchants and partner banks. I have seen how a single weak control or misconfiguration can interrupt services that people rely on for their income.

My BSc in Computer Science (Debre Tabor University, 2022) gave me the technical foundation: Computer Security, Network and System Administration, Data Communication and Computer Networks, and Distributed Systems. My final year was my strongest, with A− in Advanced Programming, Compiler Design and Complexity Theory.

What I lack is the systematic, organisational side of security: risk assessment, security management, governance and the human factors your programme covers [name 2 courses from the programme page]. Stockholm University's combination of technical and management perspectives is exactly what an engineer needs to build secure financial infrastructure in a country moving quickly to digital payments.

After graduating I will return to Ethiopia's financial sector to lead security and reliability work, and share what I learn with colleagues and students.

Yours sincerely, [Passport name]

5. Documents and required formats

Document	Format	Where	Status
Degree certificate + transcripts (all years)	Officially issued; **transcript sent directly by DTU** (official e-mail to verifications@uhr.se, or sealed post)	universityadmissions.se, by **1 Feb**	Registrar request (in the Document Collection Kit)
Passport copy	Clear PDF showing name, citizenship, photo	Both portals	You
Application fee	**SEK 900**, once per semester, by 1 Feb	universityadmissions.se	**Pay after the 4 programmes are fixed**
SI CV	**SI 2027/2028 template only**, ≤ 3 pages; Europass is disqualified	SI portal	Content ready: `06_FINAL_CV/CV_content_for_SI_template`
Proof of Work and Leadership	SI template; up to 3 work forms + 2 leadership forms; one PDF ≤ 5 pages; **signed and stamped**	SI portal	After HR letters
2 reference letters	SI template; signed and stamped; at least 1 work-based	SI portal	Drafts: `16_RECOMMENDATIONS/Professional_Draft_1…`, `…_2…`
Motivation	Typed in the portal, in English	SI portal	Section 4a

6. Outstanding items

1. SantimPay + Kifiya HR letters → hours proof (blocks SI eligibility).
2. 13 Nov: download the SI templates and the programme list; confirm the 4 programmes and their entry requirements.
3. Leadership example confirmed by its signatory.
4. Two referees agree to use SI's template.
5. DTU sends the transcript to UHR (registrar request).
6. Pay SEK 900 (after step 2).

7. Submission guide

1. **By 15 Jan:** on universityadmissions.se, create the account, add the 4 programmes in preference order, and submit.
2. **By 1 Feb:** pay SEK 900. Upload the degree certificate and passport; confirm that DTU's transcript has reached UHR.
3. **8–24 Feb (closes 14:59 CET):** in the SI portal, upload the SI CV, the work and leadership PDF, the 2 references and the passport, and paste the motivation. **Submit early**: SI warns that the portal slows down near the deadline.
4. **1 Apr:** admission results. **22 Apr:** SI results.

8. Final audit checklist

- [ ] Every programme is on SI's 2027/28 list
- [ ] The "SI hours - no double count" sheet shows **MEETS** with E0/E1 evidence only
- [ ] CV in the SI template, ≤ 3 pages; dates identical to the HR letters and forms
- [ ] Work + leadership forms signed **and stamped**; one PDF ≤ 5 pages; work forms first, newest first
- [ ] References on the SI template, signed and stamped; referees available until 22 Apr
- [ ] Motivation links the programmes to specific SDGs
- [ ] Fee paid; transcript received by UHR by 1 Feb
- [ ] Submitted before 24 Feb, 14:59 CET; confirmation saved

9. Employer documentation pack (for HR with the SI form)

SI's **Proof of Work and Leadership Experience 2027/2028** form is published on 13 Nov. Until then, the HR request letters already ask for the same facts.

When the template is out, give HR:

1. The blank SI form, typed (not handwritten), with your details filled in.
2. A one-page summary for HR, matching their records:
   - **Job titles and periods**: exactly as in their records, one line per title
   - **Hours per week** and **weeks worked per year** (minus leave): SI's formula uses both
   - **Type**: full-time or part-time employee
   - **Duties**: 3–4 lines, consistent with the HR letter
3. **Signature** by someone who knows your work on behalf of the employer (the HR manager is acceptable) **and the official company stamp** (or a notary stamp).
4. Ask HR to **keep a copy**: SI may contact the referee until 22 Apr 2027.

Before you upload:

- check that every date matches the HR letter and your CV
- scan everything in colour into **one PDF**: work forms first, newest first; then leadership forms
- the PDF must be at most 5 pages

10. Leadership statement builder (SI definition)

SI defines leadership as **leading other colleagues or organisations, a mandate to influence the development strategy, allocating tasks, and/or familiarity with decision-making processes**. Priority goes to strong, relevant leadership **from employment**.

Use up to **two** examples (one leadership form each). Fill only with real events:

Element	Example 1 [⏳]	Example 2 [⏳]
Organisation and period		
Your mandate (what you were responsible for)		

Element	Example 1 [⏳]	Example 2 [⏳]
People you led, coordinated or trained (number, roles)		
Decisions you made or influenced		
Result (a number only if real)		
Who signs the form (name, title)		

Candidate examples (confirm or discard):

- coordinating a POS rollout or merchant onboarding (P3)
- leading the response to a production incident (P2)
- Dereja co-training (civil society; P8)

11. 13 November procedure

1. **Download** from the SI programme page:
   - the 2027/2028 CV template
   - the Proof of Work and Leadership template
   - the reference template
   - the eligible-programme list

   Save them in this folder.
2. **Compare** with this package. Check:
   - CV page limit (3 pages in 2026/27)
   - how many work and leadership forms are allowed (3 + 2)
   - whether one form per employer or per job title
   - the 3,000-hour rule
   - the 8 Feb cut-off
   - stamp and signature rules

   Note every change at the top of this file.
3. **Mark** “On SI list?” in `SI_Programme_Shortlist.xlsx`. Choose **4** programmes, using the ranking logic in that file:
   - formal requirements met
   - selection uses more than grades
   - alignment
   - career value
4. **Check** each chosen programme’s page for extra documents. For example, Stockholm asks for new supporting documentation for autumn 2027.
5. **Then pay SEK 900** on universityadmissions.se (fee deadline 1 Feb; review starts only after payment).

6. **Hours:** enter the HR-letter data in `Employment_Evidence_Collection_Form_v2.xlsx`. The sheet “SI hours - no double count” must show “MEETS”.
7. **Forms:** fill the SI work forms (one per employer, unless the template says otherwise) and up to 2 leadership forms. Have them signed and stamped.
8. **CV:** paste `06_FINAL_CV/CV_content_for_SI_template` into the official template (at most 3 pages).